

Economics Week Ahead

Weekly

Economist(s)



[Tom Porcelli](#)



[Tim Quinlan](#)



[Sarah House](#)



[Aroop Chatterjee](#)



[Charlie Dougherty](#)



[Michael Pugliese](#)



[Brendan McKenna](#)



[Jackie Benson](#)



[Shannon Grein](#)



[Nicole Cervi](#)

United States:

- [Personal Income & Spending](#) (Thursday), [Consumer Price Index \(CPI\)](#) (Friday)

G10 Economies:

- [Canada Labor Force Survey](#) (Friday)

Emerging Markets:

- [Reserve Bank of India](#) (Wednesday), [Mexico CPI](#) (Thursday), [Brazil CPI](#) (Friday)

Wells Fargo Economics Week Ahead

United States

Indicator Releases		Period	Consensus	Wells Fargo	Prior
6-Apr	ISM Services	Mar	54.9	56.8	56.1
7-Apr	Durable Goods Orders (MoM)	Feb	-1.0%	-1.6%	0.0%
7-Apr	Durable Goods Ex Transportation (MoM)	Feb	0.5%	0.6%	0.4%
9-Apr	Personal Income (MoM)	Feb	0.3%	0.3%	0.4%
9-Apr	Personal Spending (MoM)	Feb	0.6%	0.7%	0.4%
9-Apr	PCE (MoM)	Feb	0.4%	0.4%	0.3%
9-Apr	PCE (YoY)	Feb	2.8%	2.8%	2.8%
9-Apr	Core PCE (MoM)	Feb	0.3%	0.4%	0.4%
9-Apr	Core PCE (YoY)	Feb	2.9%	3.0%	3.1%
10-Apr	CPI (MoM)	Mar	0.9%	1.0%	0.3%
10-Apr	CPI (YoY)	Mar	3.4%	3.4%	2.4%
10-Apr	Core CPI (MoM)	Mar	0.3%	0.3%	0.2%
10-Apr	Core CPI (YoY)	Mar	2.7%	2.7%	2.5%
10-Apr	CPI Index NSA	Mar	330,720	330,698	326,785
10-Apr	Factory Orders	Feb	-0.3%	0.2%	0.1%

Fed Speakers (*Designating 2026 Voting Member)

7-Apr	Fed's Goolsbee in Moderated Q&A on Economy and Monetary Policy (12:35p ET)
8-Apr	March FOMC Minutes Released (2:00p ET)

International

G10 Economies		Period	Consensus	Wells Fargo	Prior
10-Apr	Canada Net Change in Employment	Mar	15.0K	20.0K	-83.9K
10-Apr	Canada Unemployment Rate	Mar	6.8%	6.7%	6.7%

Emerging Markets		Period	Consensus	Wells Fargo	Prior
8-Apr	Reserve Bank of India Policy Rate	8-Apr	5.25%	5.25%	5.25%
9-Apr	Mexico CPI (YoY)	Mar	4.65%	—	4.02%
9-Apr	Mexico Core CPI (YoY)	Mar	4.46%	—	4.50%
10-Apr	Brazil CPI (YoY)	Mar	—	—	3.81%

Forecast as of April 02, 2026

Source: Bloomberg Finance, L.P. and Wells Fargo Economics

Related Information:

- [U.S. Economic Forecast](#)
- [FOMC 101](#)
- [U.S. Tariff Tracker](#)
- [U.S. Tariff Policy 101](#)
- [2026 Economic Calendar](#)

U.S. Week Ahead

Personal Income & Spending • Thursday

U.S. economic data remain somewhat stale due to the lingering effects of last year's prolonged federal government shutdown. The upcoming Personal Income & Spending report is a case in point, with next week's release covering February activity—already about a month old. That lag feels more consequential amid ongoing tensions with Iran. High-frequency credit-card data through March suggest consumers remain resilient for now, but the risk of a slowdown grows the longer uncertainty persists, particularly if gasoline prices continue to climb sharply.

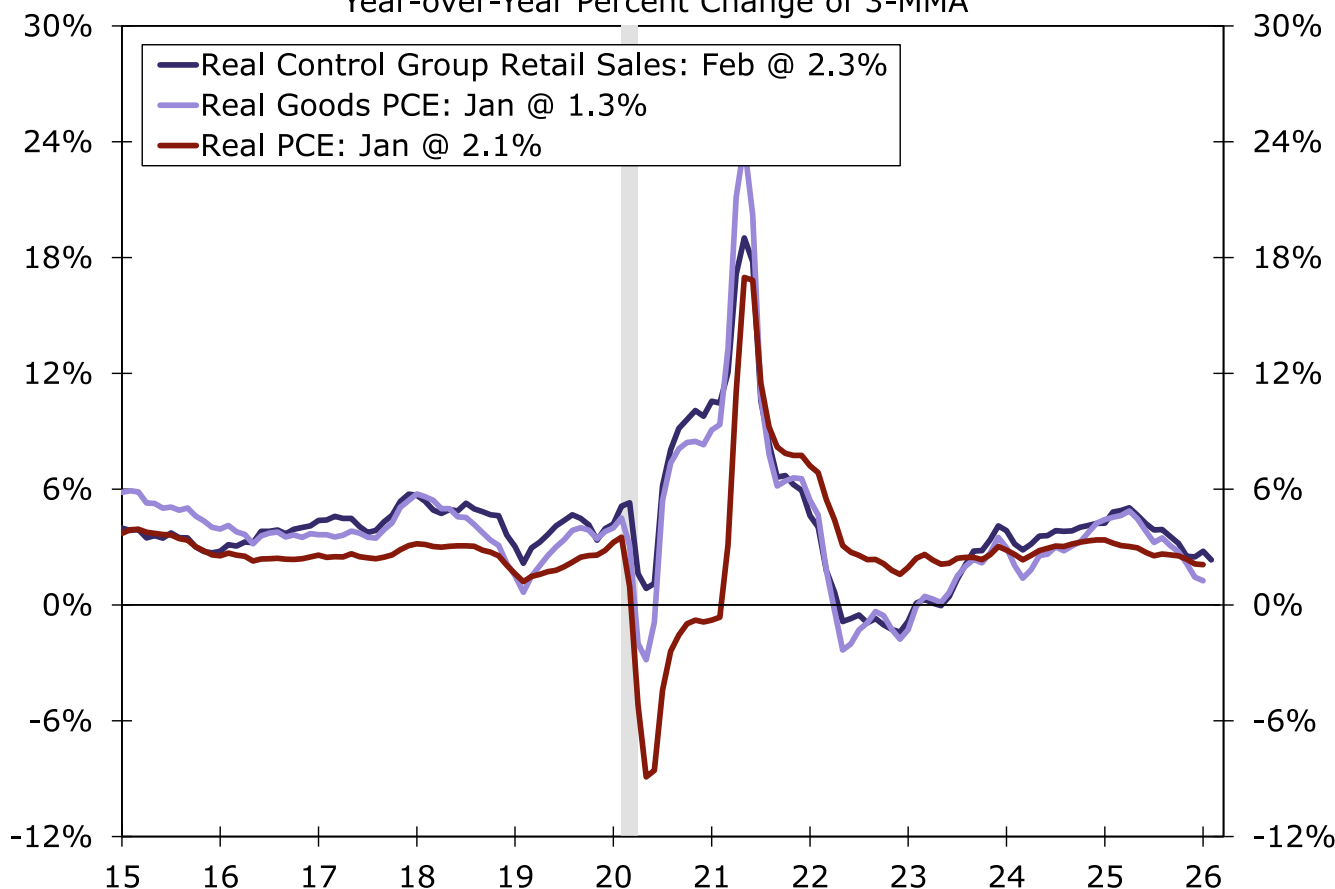
Looking at February, we expect personal spending to rise 0.7%. Solid retail sales—up 0.6% on the month, with the control group advancing 0.5%—point to healthy goods demand ([chart](#)), while firmer restaurant spending indicates continued momentum in services. That said, much of the nominal strength reflects higher prices. We expect the PCE deflator increased 0.4%, implying real spending rose a still-solid but more modest 0.3%. We forecast personal income to increase 0.3%, reflecting some normalization after January's boost from the Social Security cost-of-living adjustment.

([Return](#))

Real Control Group Retail Sales vs. PCE

Sales Ex. Food Services, Gasoline, Building Materials & Autos;

Year-over-Year Percent Change of 3-MMA



Source: U.S. Department of Commerce and Wells Fargo Economics

Consumer Price Index (CPI) • Friday

The March CPI report will put an abrupt end to the gradual disinflationary trend in place over the past two years. We estimate consumer prices rose 1.0% in March, leading to a year-over-year increase of 3.4% ([table](#)). Unsurprisingly, energy goods—largely gasoline—will account for the lion's share (~70 bps) of March's monthly increase as higher oil prices have quickly fed through to prices at the pump. Airline fares are expected to be another source of strength in March and drive public transportation prices up 7%, although we expect the recent surge in jet fuel to lead to an even larger rise in airfares in April.

We do not expect to see the effects of the Middle East conflict immediately feeding into other categories of inflation, however. Despite higher prices for LNG exports, domestic natural gas prices have been little changed, which should limit near-term energy services inflation. Meantime, food at home is likely to moderate in March thanks to giveback in the volatile fruits & vegetable component.

March 2026 Forecast

	Month-over-Month % Change		Year-over-Year % Change	
	Forecast	Prior	Forecast	Prior
<i>Seasonally Adjusted</i>	Mar.	Feb.	Mar.	Feb.
CPI (Consensus)	0.9	---	3.4	---
CPI (WF Estimate)	0.98	0.27	3.4	2.4
Food	0.17	0.39	2.9	3.1
Food at Home	0.10	0.44	2.3	2.6
Food Away from Home	0.28	0.32	3.8	3.9
Energy	11.30	0.63	13.0	0.4
Energy Goods	23.03	1.10	21.1	-5.2
Energy Services	0.50	0.17	5.1	6.3
Core CPI (Consensus)	0.30	---	2.7	---
Core CPI (WF Estimate)	0.30	0.22	2.7	2.5
Goods	0.16	0.08	1.3	1.0
Vehicles	0.25	-0.13	-0.7	-1.0
Other Goods	0.11	0.19	2.3	2.1
Services	0.34	0.27	3.2	2.9
Primary Shelter	0.25	0.20	3.0	3.1
"Super Core"*	0.47	0.29	3.6	2.9
<i>Not Seasonally Adjusted</i>	Index	MoM (%)	YoY (%)	
CPI (Consensus)	330.720	—	—	
CPI (WF Estimate)	330.698	1.20	3.4	

Forecast as of: April 02, 2026; Bloomberg Consensus

*Core services CPI excluding rent of primary residence and owners' equivalent rent (i.e., excluding "Primary Shelter")

Source: Source: U.S. Department of Labor, Bloomberg Finance L.P. and Wells Fargo Economics

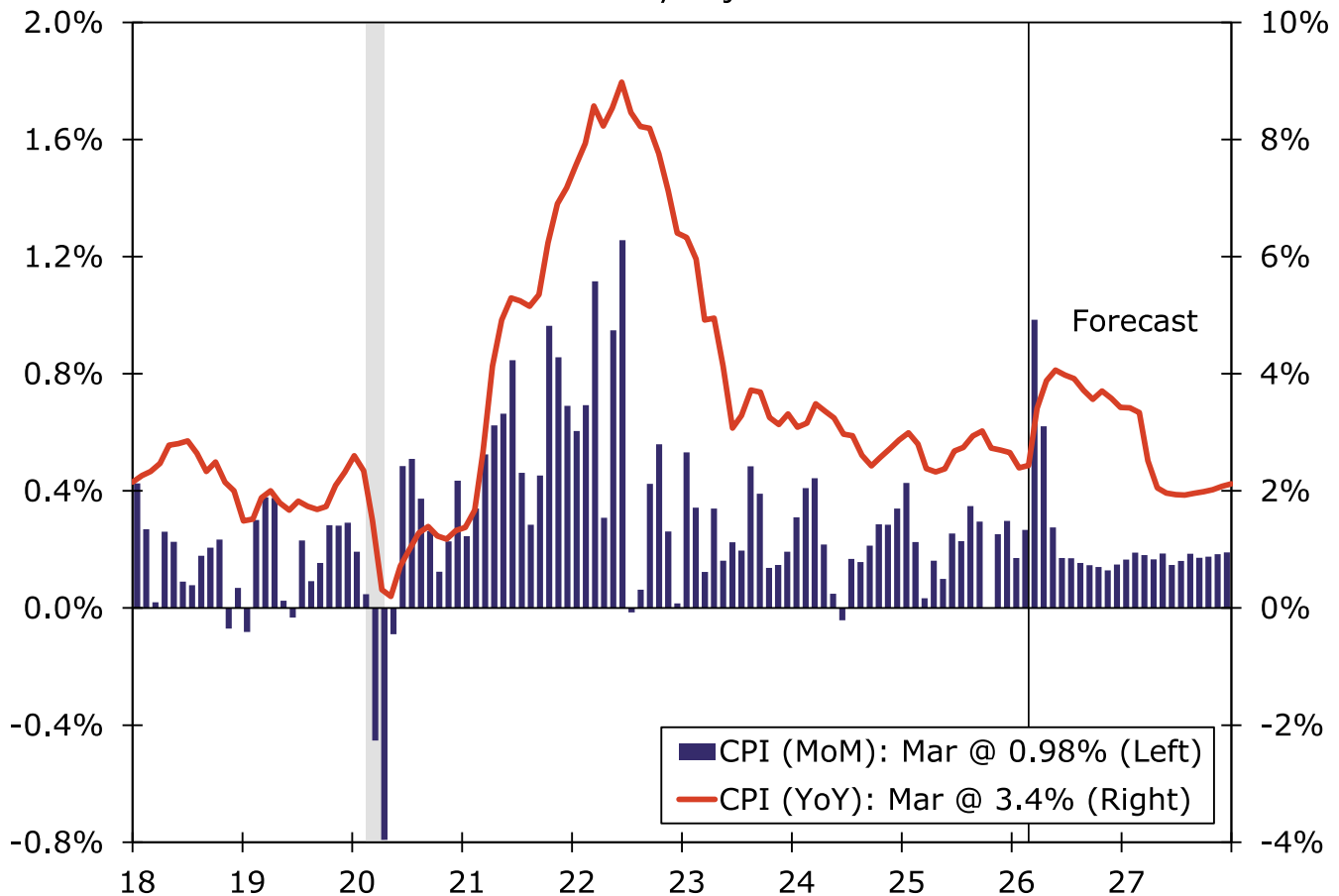
Within the core, we look for a modest strengthening in goods primarily due to a rebound in used auto prices. Core services is likely to match the 0.3% gain registered in February, as the expected jump in airline fares is largely offset by mean-reversion in medical care services and further softness in motor vehicle insurance. We anticipate primary shelter rose 0.25%, roughly in-line with its three-month average.

The recent oil shock is likely to dominate the view of inflation in March, but we expect the details to suggest that the modest downward trend in core CPI was already struggling to be maintained. A sustained increase in oil will further complicate progress in reducing inflation as higher production and transportation costs slowly seep into some core categories. Yet, the reduction in household purchasing power caused by higher gasoline prices is likely to limit the ability for some companies to pass on higher costs. We expect the year-over-year rate of core CPI to be stuck in the range of 2.7%–3.1% through the remainder of this year as a result ([chart](#)).

([Return](#))

Consumer Price Index

Seasonally Adjusted



Source: U.S. Department of Labor and Wells Fargo Economics

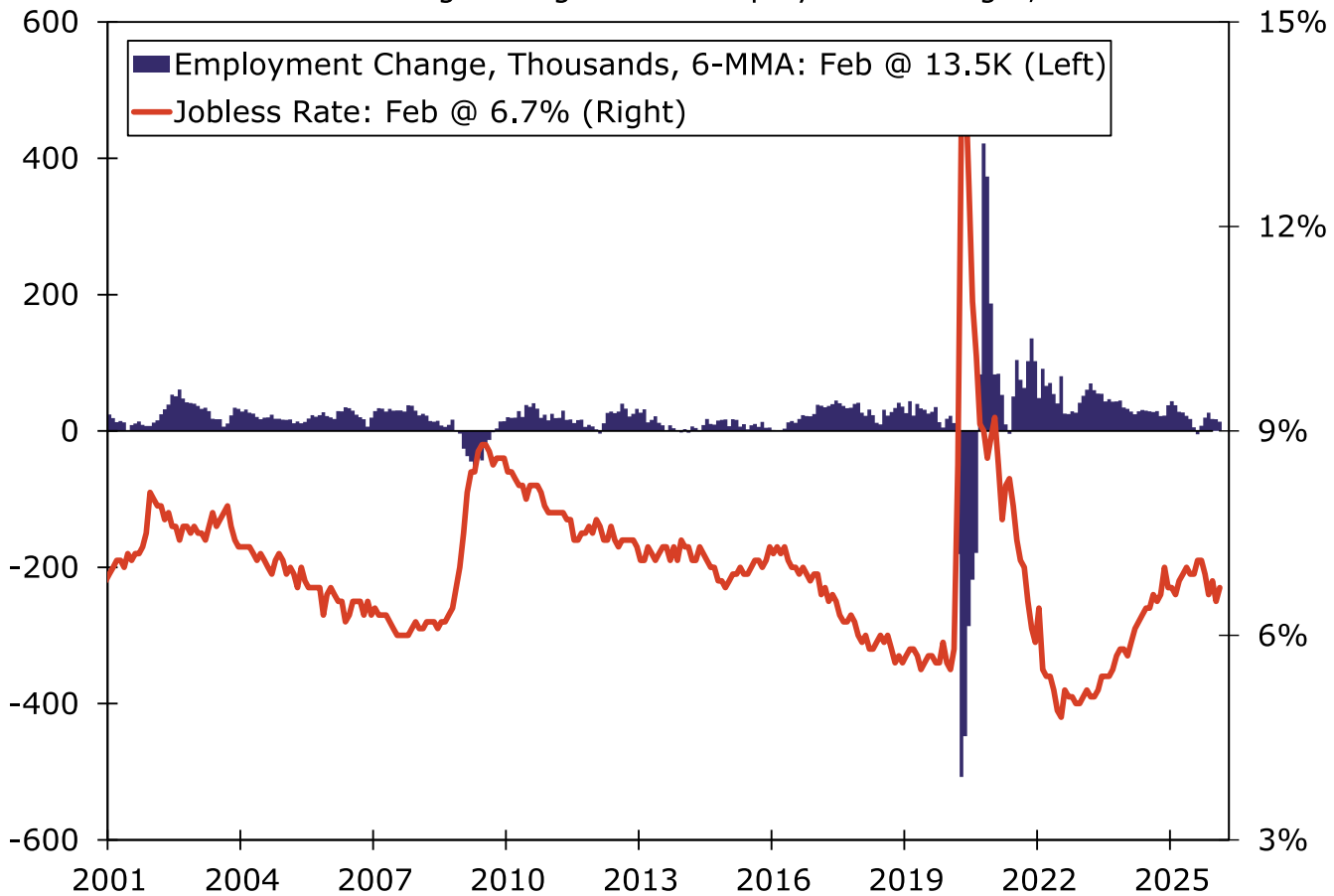
G10 Week Ahead

Canada Labor Force Survey • Friday

We look for Canada's March Labor Force Survey (LFS) to rebound from the soft January/February prints with +20K jobs, with the unemployment rate steady at 6.7%. Risks are asymmetric: upside to the jobs number and downside to the unemployment rate. The near-term story is a labor market that's stable, not collapsing—with the main fragility still concentrated in manufacturing and trade-exposed goods, while services, health care, energy and the public sector continue to look relatively resilient. That sector mix should be increasingly shaped by U.S. tariff exposure, the recent surge in energy prices and the impending USMCA review. Structurally, the backdrop has shifted: a shrinking population (net outflow of temporary residents) and an aging workforce are lowering labor force growth—and with it the monthly job threshold needed to keep unemployment stable. The implication is that the unemployment rate can drift lower even with only modest job creation over the coming months. A steadier labor market, in turn, likely tilts the Bank of Canada's (BoC) focus back toward inflation. We continue to see the BoC stuck on hold as it assesses the energy-price shock and the risk of inflation persistence/feedback. April still looks far too early for a move, but the Monetary Policy Report should offer a clearer read on the BoC's reaction function. We still pencil in a Q3 (July) hike, with the risk of a later hike this year depending on the intensity and persistence of energy and commodity price pressures.

Canadian Labor Market

6-Month Moving Average of Net Employment Change ; Rate



[\(Return\)](#)

EM Week Ahead

Reserve Bank of India • Wednesday

Reserve Bank of India (RBI) policymakers will assess monetary policy settings next week for the first time since the oil price shock, and we expect interest rates to be left on hold. Prior to events in the Middle East, RBI policymakers were inching closer to ending the easing cycle, but perhaps maintained a slight bias for additional rate cuts. With oil prices likely to push headline inflation sharply higher in the coming months and keep the rupee under pressure, we have our doubts the bias remains for additional rate cuts. In fact, through our forecast horizon, we believe rates in India will be kept unchanged as inflation pressures build and INR remains on the back foot.

But the RBI, like many other central banks, is caught in between an inflation and a growth shock. The age-old question will loom for the RBI: support growth or contain inflation? Inflation is likely to be the priority for policymakers, but the economy is set to soften given India's status as a major oil importer. Softening growth could keep the bias for policymakers tilted toward rate cuts. But, in our view, with the economy still likely to grow 6.5%–7% this calendar year, perhaps the need to lower policy rates is not that pressing. Either way, we will get more insight into the RBI thought process and how they consider this trade-off next week.

[\(Return\)](#)

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and Wells Fargo Economics

Mexico CPI • Thursday

For Mexico watchers, the path of inflation has been top of mind. Not only to get a sense of the future direction of Banxico monetary policy but also to gauge whether financial markets will deem prior Banxico easing as a policy error. March inflation should show headline CPI popping higher to reflect the spike in energy prices. At the same time, core inflation, the measure that strips out elevated energy costs, is likely to remain flat. Policymakers have been more focused on sluggish growth prospects to rationalize lowering interest rates, but another key component to justify easing monetary policy has been policymakers' view that core inflationary pressures are muted.

A flat March core inflation print combined with a softening growth outlook, in our view, should continue to give policymakers rationale to cut policy rates at least one more time. Just recently, we adjusted our Banxico outlook to reflect our view for a terminal rate of 6.50% by mid-year. For now, that forecast remains in place, but we also flagged the possibility that Banxico has lowered rates too much. Risks on the horizon such as trade and political uncertainty, could prompt capital flight as carry associated with the peso has been eroded over time. Even a further shift in risk sentiment from the oil price shock can drive a repricing of local financial markets that ultimately prompts as aggressive *tightening* cycle that keeps growth weighed down for an extended period of time.

[\(Return\)](#)

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and Wells Fargo Economics

Brazil CPI • Friday

While Brazil is one of the economies a bit more shielded from higher energy prices, the inflationary impulse of a spike in energy costs will still materialize. To that point, we expect year-over-year headline inflation to rise close to, possibly back above, 4% when March data are released next week. The balance of risk is shifted toward a firmer rise in inflation, and with inflation expectations already reacting to the rise in energy prices, policymakers are also in reaction mode. To that point, fiscal authorities have already deployed policy to offset the rise in energy prices for households. And monetary policymakers are communicating more caution when considering further reductions in interest rates.

The rise in March inflation should keep fiscal and monetary policymakers busy, but also on guard going forward. For fiscal policy, President Lula is likely to deploy subsidies and other forms of financial support ahead of his re-election campaign. Brazilian Central Bankers are also likely to keep the gradual pace of rate reductions in place, possibly even keep rates steady, to defend against unanchored inflation expectations from materializing. Combined with geopolitical tensions that do not seem to be receding all that quickly, this policy mix could be in place for an extended period of time.

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and Wells Fargo Economics

[\(Return\)](#)

Economics Group

Tom Porcelli	Chief Economist	212-214-6422	Tom.Porcelli@wellsfargo.com
Tim Quinlan	Senior Economist	704-410-3283	Tim.Quinlan@wellsfargo.com
Sarah House	Senior Economist	704-410-3282	Sarah.House@wellsfargo.com
Aroop Chatterjee	Senior Economist	212-214-8819	Aroop.Chatterjee@wellsfargo.com
Charlie Dougherty	Senior Economist	212-214-8984	Charles.Dougherty@wellsfargo.com
Michael Pugliese	Senior Economist	212-214-5058	Michael.D.Pugliese@wellsfargo.com
Brendan McKenna	International Economist	212-214-5637	Brendan.Mckenna@wellsfargo.com
Jackie Benson	Economist	704-410-4468	Jackie.Benson@wellsfargo.com
Shannon Grein	Economist	704-410-0369	Shannon.Grein@wellsfargo.com
Nicole Cervi	Economist	704-410-3059	Nicole.Cervi@wellsfargo.com
Delaney Conner	Economic Analyst	704-374-2150	Delaney.Conner@wellsfargo.com
Ali Hajibeigi	Economic Analyst	212-214-8253	Ali.Hajibeigi@wellsfargo.com
Azhin Abdulkarim	Economic Analyst	212-214-5154	Azhin.Abdulkarim@wellsfargo.com
Anagha Sridharan	Economic Analyst	704-410-6212	Anagha.Sridharan@wellsfargo.com
Andrew Thompson	Economic Analyst	704-410-2911	Andrew.L.Thompson@wellsfargo.com

All estimates/forecasts are as of 4/2/2026 unless otherwise stated. 4/2/2026 13:51:40 EDT.

Required Disclosures

This report is produced by the Economics Group of Wells Fargo Securities, LLC ("Wells Fargo Securities"). This report is not a product of Wells Fargo Global Research and the information contained in this report is not financial research. Wells Fargo Securities distributes this report directly and through affiliates including, but not limited to, Wells Fargo & Company, Wells Fargo Bank, N.A., Wells Fargo Clearing Services, LLC, Wells Fargo Securities International Limited, Wells Fargo Securities Europe S.A., and Wells Fargo Securities Canada, Ltd. Wells Fargo Securities, LLC is registered with the Commodity Futures Trading Commission as a futures commission merchant and is a member in good standing of the National Futures Association. WFBNA is registered with the Commodity Futures Trading Commission as a swap dealer and is a member in good standing of the National Futures

Association. Wells Fargo Securities, LLC and WFBNA are generally engaged in the trading of futures and derivative products, any of which may be discussed within this report. All reports published by the Economics Group are disseminated and available to all clients simultaneously through electronic publication to our internal client website. Clients may also receive our reports via third party vendors. We are not responsible for the redistribution of our reports by third-party aggregators. Any external website links included in this report are not maintained, controlled or operated by Wells Fargo Securities. Wells Fargo Securities does not provide the products and services on these websites and the views expressed on these websites do not necessarily represent those of Wells Fargo Securities.

This publication has been prepared for informational purposes only and is not intended as a recommendation, offer or solicitation with respect to the purchase or sale of any security or other financial product, nor does it constitute professional advice. The information in this report has been obtained or derived from sources believed by Wells Fargo Securities to be reliable, but has not been independently verified by Wells Fargo Securities, may not be current, and Wells Fargo Securities has no obligation to provide any updates or changes. All price references and market forecasts are as of the date of the report or such earlier date as may be indicated for a particular price or forecast. The views and opinions expressed in this report are those of its named author(s) or, where no author is indicated, the Economics Group; such views and opinions are not necessarily those of Wells Fargo Securities and may differ from the views and opinions of other departments or divisions of Wells Fargo Securities and its affiliates. Wells Fargo Securities is not providing any financial, economic, legal, accounting, or tax advice or recommendations in this report. Neither Wells Fargo Securities nor any of its affiliates makes any representation or warranty, express or implied, as to the accuracy or completeness of the statements or any information contained in this report, and any liability therefore (including in respect of direct, indirect or consequential loss or damage) is expressly disclaimed. Wells Fargo Securities is a separate legal entity and distinct from affiliated banks, and is a wholly-owned subsidiary of Wells Fargo & Company.

You are permitted to store, display, analyze, modify, reformat, copy, duplicate and reproduce this report and the information contained within it for your own use and for no other purpose. Without the prior written consent of Wells Fargo Securities, no part of this report may be copied, duplicated or reproduced in any form by any other means. In addition, this report and its contents may not be redistributed or transmitted to any other party in whole or in part, directly or indirectly, including by means of any AI Technologies (defined below) through which this report or any portion thereof may be accessible by any third-party. "AI Technologies" means any deep learning, machine learning, and other artificial intelligence technologies, including without limitation any and all (a) proprietary algorithms, software, or systems that make use of or employ neural networks, statistical learning algorithms (such as linear and logistic regression, support vector machines, random forests or k-means clustering) or reinforcement learning, or curated data sets accessible by any of the foregoing or (b) proprietary embodied artificial intelligence and related hardware or equipment. In addition, certain text, images, graphics, screenshots and audio or video clips included in this report are protected by copyright law and owned by Wells Fargo Securities, its affiliates or one or more third parties (collectively, "Protected Content"). Protected Content is made available to clients by Wells Fargo under license or otherwise in accordance with applicable law. Any use or publication of Protected Content included in this report for purposes other than fair use requires permission from Wells Fargo Securities or, in the case of content attributed to any third party, the third-party copyright owner. You may not alter, obscure, or remove any copyright, trademark or any other notices attached to or contained within this report. All rights not expressly granted herein are reserved by Wells Fargo Securities or the third-party providers from whom Wells Fargo Securities has obtained the applicable information. © 2026 Wells Fargo Securities, LLC

Important Information for Non-U.S. Recipients

For recipients in the United Kingdom, this report is distributed by Wells Fargo Securities International Limited ("WFSIL"). WFSIL is a U.K. incorporated investment firm authorized and regulated by the Financial Conduct Authority ("FCA"). For the purposes of Section 21 of the UK Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (the "Act"), the content of this report has been approved by WFSIL, an authorized person under the Act. WFSIL does not deal with retail clients as defined in the Directive 2014/65/EU ("MiFID2"). The FCA rules made under the Act for the protection of retail clients will therefore not apply, nor will the Financial Services Compensation Scheme be available. For recipients in the EFTA, this report is distributed by WFSIL. For recipients in the EU, it is distributed by Wells Fargo Securities Europe S.A. ("WFSE"). WFSE is a French incorporated investment firm authorized and regulated by the Autorité de contrôle prudentiel et de résolution and the Autorité des marchés financiers. WFSE does not deal with retail clients as defined in MiFID2. This report is not intended for, and should not be relied upon by, retail clients.

SECURITIES: NOT FDIC-INSURED - MAY LOSE VALUE - NO BANK GUARANTEE